# SNAPCHAT

## THE BASICS PARENTS NEED TO KNOW

Snapchat is a photo and video messaging app where messages (Snaps) disappear after being viewed. It's fun and creative – but it also comes with risks. Here's what parents need to know.

**800M+** monthly active Snapchat users worldwide — Snap Inc. (2024)

**75%** of 13–34 year olds in the US use Snapchat — Pew Research (2023)

**30+** minutes per day is the average time teens spend on Snapchat — DataReportal (2024)

**TOP 3** app teens say they use most to stay in touch with friends — Pew Research (2023)

## KEY FEATURES – WHAT MAKES SNAPCHAT DIFFERENT

**SNAPS**
Photos or videos that disappear after being viewed (1–10 seconds by default).

**STORIES**
Snaps that last 24 hours and can be viewed by friends or everyone (public story).

**SNAP MAP**
Shows your location on a map to friends who have location sharing on.

**CHAT**
Messages disappear by default after being viewed in chat.

**STREAKS**
You and a friend send Snaps back and forth for consecutive days to keep a Streak.

**SPOTLIGHT**
Public feed of user-submitted Snaps. Anyone can view, like and share.

**SNAP SCORE**
A score that goes up when you send/receive Snaps. Many teens focus on getting higher.

## WHY KIDS LOVE SNAPCHAT

- It feels private and "in the moment"
- Fun filters, Lenses and creative tools
- Easy way to stay in touch with friends
- Streaks create connection and routine
- Stories and Spotlight help them express themselves

## RISKS PARENTS SHOULD KNOW

- **Disappearing doesn't mean gone.** Screenshots, screen recordings and camera photos can save Snaps.
- **Strangers can contact your child.** Anyone can send a Chat or view a public Story/Spotlight.
- **Location sharing can expose them.** Snap Map can reveal where your child is – in real time.
- **Inappropriate content exists.** Spotlight and Stories can include sensitive or explicit content.
- **Pressure & comparison.** Streaks, Snap Score and filters can affect self-esteem.

## SNAPCHAT PRIVACY: WHAT PARENTS CAN CONTROL

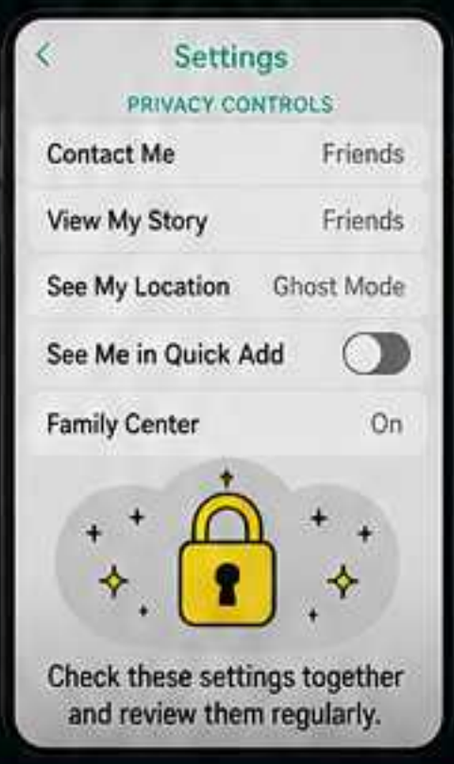
**Who can contact them**
Restrict to "Friends" so only accepted friends can message.

**View My Story**
Limit to "Friends" or "Custom" instead of "Everyone".

**See My Location (Snap Map)**
Choose "Ghost Mode" or "My Friends (except...)" for more privacy.

**See Me in Quick Add**
Turn off so your child isn't suggested to people they don't know.

**Family Center**
Connect with your teen to see their privacy settings and who they've friended (not content).




Check these settings together and review them regularly.

## TIPS FOR PARENTS

- **Talk early and often.** Keep the conversation open and judgment-free.
- **Know their friends.** Help them understand who's safe to talk to.
- **Review privacy settings together.** Make them part of the process.
- **Be aware of Snap Map.** Talk about location sharing and safety.
- **Discuss what's not okay.** Set clear boundaries around content and behavior.
- **Encourage them to speak up.** If something feels off, tell a trusted adult.

## CONVERSATION STARTERS

- Who do you like talking to online?
- What's fun about that game/app?"
- Has anyone ever made you feel weird or uncomfortable online?"
- What would you do if someone asked for a photo or a secret?'
- "I'm always here if something doesn't feel right."

## SAFETY RULES THAT HELP

- Never share personal info (name, address, school or photos).
- Don't share or send nudes. It's unsafe, illegal and can't be taken back.
- Don't meet online friends. People can lie about who they are.
- Tell a trusted adult if something feels wrong, upsetting or confusing.
- Block and report. You don't have to respond.

## RED FLAGS TO SPOT

- Love-bombing or over-the-top attention
- Asking for secrets or personal photos
- Moving to private chat quickly
- Pressure for streaks or replies
- Jealousy or control
- Threats or blackmail

## QUICK DO'S & DON'TS

**DO**
- Encourage open conversations.
- Know their username and friends.
- Review privacy settings together.
- Praise good choices.
- Be a trusted place for help.

**DON'T**
- Spy or snoop.
- Overreact—listen first.
- Stereotype all online friends.
- Ignore problems.
- Blame or judge.

## WHERE TO GET HELP

**Childline**
0800 1111
childline.org.uk

**The Mix**
0808 808 4994
themix.org.uk

**Internet Matters**
internetmatters.org
Advice, guides and tools for parents

## REMEMBER

Your involvement today helps your child make safer choices tomorrow.

**NEED TO TALK?**
**CHILDLINE 0800 1111**

**0800 1111**
childline.org.uk

**YOU ARE NOT ALONE** We're here for you.